

National Higher National Diploma Examination 2026 Session

Specialty: ALL

Exam Paper: ENGLISH LANGUAGE

Credit value: 2

Instruction: This exam paper carries four sections: A-B-C-D. You are required to answer all questions on exam paper except section D to be written in the composition booklet.

SECTION A: READING COMPREHENSION (20mks)

Read the passage below and answer the questions that follow

The Evolution of Artificial Intelligence

Artificial Intelligence (AI) has transformed from a conceptual idea into a pivotal technology driving progress in numerous fields. The term "artificial intelligence" was first coined in 1956 during a conference at Dartmouth College, where researchers aimed to explore the possibility of creating machines that could mimic human thought. Early AI systems were limited, often performing simple tasks like playing chess or solving basic equations. However, they laid the foundation for the development of more advanced systems.

AI operates through algorithms, which are sets of instructions that allow machines to process data and learn from patterns. Machine learning, a subset of AI, enables computers to improve their performance over time without explicit programming. A notable example is neural networks, which simulate the way the human brain processes information. These networks have been instrumental in the advancement of technologies such as voice recognition, image processing, and natural language understanding.

Today, AI is deeply embedded in our daily lives. Smartphones use AI-powered virtual assistants to help users manage their schedules, access information, and communicate with others. Social media platforms leverage AI to personalize content, recommend connections, and moderate harmful posts. In healthcare, AI has revolutionized diagnostics, enabling early detection of diseases like cancer through image analysis. It is also helping develop treatments by analyzing vast amounts of clinical data.

Despite its benefits, the rapid advancement of AI raises ethical and practical concerns. One of the primary issues is the displacement of human workers due to automation. For instance, industries such as manufacturing and customer service have seen significant changes as robots and chatbots replace traditional roles. Furthermore, the use of AI in surveillance and data collection has sparked debates about privacy and misuse of personal information.

Governments and organizations worldwide are working to establish regulations that balance innovation with ethical considerations. International collaborations aim to create frameworks that ensure AI development is transparent, equitable, and beneficial for humanity. Meanwhile, researchers are exploring ways to build AI systems that align with human values and prioritize safety.

The evolution of AI continues to accelerate, promising advancements in areas like autonomous transportation, renewable energy, and space exploration. However, its future depends on how societies address the challenges it presents and harness its potential for the greater good.

Questions

1. When was the term "artificial intelligence" first coined? (2 marks)
A) 1945

- B) 1956
- C) 1969
- D) 1980

2. **What is a neural network, and how does it relate to AI? (2 marks)**
 - A) A computer system that processes basic arithmetic
 - B) A simulation of the human brain's processing of information
 - C) A database for storing data about AI systems
 - D) A tool for programming explicit instructions into AI
3. **What is one example of AI in healthcare mentioned in the text? (2 marks)**
 - A) Predicting stock market trends
 - B) Diagnosing diseases through image analysis
 - C) Moderating content on social media platforms
 - D) Operating industrial machinery
4. **What is one ethical concern related to the advancement of AI? (2 marks)**
 - A) AI systems are too slow for practical use.
 - B) AI does not collect enough data for decision-making.
 - C) The potential misuse of AI for surveillance and privacy breaches.
 - D) AI cannot be applied to renewable energy.
5. **How are governments addressing AI-related challenges? (2 marks)**
 - A) By banning AI research and development
 - B) By creating frameworks for transparent and ethical AI development
 - C) By encouraging the replacement of human workers
 - D) By focusing only on AI applications in space exploration
6. **What does machine learning enable computers to do? (2 marks)**
 - A) Follow explicit programming instructions
 - B) Improve their performance through experience
 - C) Operate without any data input
 - D) Solve only pre-programmed problems
7. **What role does AI play in social media? (2 marks)**
 - A) It moderates medical research.
 - B) It helps manage financial data.
 - C) It personalizes content and moderates harmful posts.
 - D) It replaces human workers in manufacturing.
8. **What is the main focus of international collaborations regarding AI? (2 marks)**
 - A) To make AI systems faster
 - B) To ensure AI is aligned with human values and safety
 - C) To increase data collection capabilities
 - D) To stop AI research
9. **What is one promising area of AI advancement mentioned in the text? (2 marks)**
 - A) Retail and online shopping
 - B) Renewable energy solutions
 - C) Traditional agriculture
 - D) Construction management
10. **Summarize in one sentence the primary challenge and opportunity presented by AI. (2 marks)**

SECTION II: Grammar and Vocabulary (30 Marks)

I) GRAMMAR (15 Marks)

- a- Complete the sentences below with the correct answer from the brackets.
- If I had money, I _____ sponsor my trip to Douala. (would have, would, will) (1mk)
 - Mary did not come to school today, _____? (does he, did he, did she) (1mk)
 - He is _____ to telling lies. (used, use, uses) (1mk)
 - This is the boy _____ parents came to see us. (who's, which, whose) (1mk)
 - My parents were angry _____ me because I had failed my exams. (for, with, at) (1mk)
 - The hungry children look sad, _____? (do they, don't they, aren't they) (1mk)
 - Mary said that their uniforms _____ clean. (are, are held, were) (1mk)
 - Daddy, I did the assignment _____, nobody helped me. (yourself, myself, itself) (1mk)
 - One of the girls was wearing _____ evening dress. (a, some, an) (1mk)
 - Do you know the couple _____ children were kidnapped? (1mk)
(which, who, whose)

b- Answer True or False and underline as instructed. Write on space provided at end of each sentence. (5 Mks.)

- A noun is the name of a place, thing or time. _____ (1mk)
- Peter is early this morning. (underline noun) (1mk)
- An adjective describes a noun. _____ (1mk)
- She used to be beautiful. (underline adjective) (1mk)
- A verb is an action word. _____ (1mk)

II) VOCABULARY (15 Marks)

I) Complete the following sentences with the suitable words from the brackets. (5marks)

- We can only eat this food tomorrow, preserve it in the _____ (cupboard, refrigerator, store) (1mark)
- Mangwi is _____ of causing problems. (fun, fond, fund) (1mark)
- That day was very _____ so, we all stayed home. (doll, dull, dol) (1mark)
- If we found the key, it was by a _____ of luck. (stroke, struck, strike) (1mark)
- He is my _____. (niece, nephew, neice) (1mark)

II) Replace each underlined phrase with a suitable word from the brackets and write in the spaces provided. (5 Mks.)

- Christmas is celebrated once a year. _____ (annually, monthly, yearningly) (1mark)
- The officer asked to see her at once. _____ (occasionally, later, immediately) (1mark)
- The night watchman ran away from his duty. _____ (embraced, quit, welcome) (1mark)
- The guy is out of his mind. _____ (foolish, travelling, mindless) (1mark)
- I learnt his father has kicked the bucket. _____ (fell, hospitalised, died) (1mark)

III) Complete the following sentences with any suitable word of your choice. (5 Mks.)

- Don't walk so _____ when leading an old person. (1mark)
- How much money do you _____ in this business? (1mark)
- Love doesn't _____ anything to this lost child. (1mark)
- Bad friends will advise you not to _____ the truth. (1mark)
- They are leaving the city for good; they shall _____ come back to visit anyone. (0.5mark)
- The parcel _____ me since the owner is not here. (0.5mark)

SECTION C: SPOKEN ENGLISH (20 marks)

A. Add appropriate question tags to the following statements (5marks)

1. My mother cooks delicious meals, _____ (1mark)
2. The children are playing outside, _____ (1mark)
3. He mustn't come today, _____ (1mark)
4. The teacher hasn't come today, _____ (1mark)
5. I am in class now, _____ (1mark)

B. Change the following sentences to reported speech (5marks)

1. "What are you doing?" Stella asked Jane. _____ (1mark)
2. "Everyone must do their homework," the teacher said. _____ (1mark)
3. "We are going to sing in church, James told his neighbour." _____ (1mark)
4. "Will you go to the market today?" Michael asked me. _____ (1mark)
5. "We were in school this morning," he said. _____ (1mark)

C. Change the following sentences to passive voice (5marks)

1. James washes plates. _____ (1mark)
2. The teacher is teaching the students. _____ (1mark)
3. The man plays soccer. _____ (1mark)
4. Dogs like meat. _____ (1mark)
5. Rita wrote a letter. _____ (1mark)

D. Write the meaning of the following idioms (5 marks)

1. "A leopard can never change its spots"

(2.5marks)

2. "All that glitters is not gold"

(2.5marks)

SECTION D: COMPOSITION (30marks)

Choose any one of the following topics and write a composition of not less than 450 to 500 words

1. The position of accountant has been advertised in SOSUCAM. Apply for this position through the director of financial affairs in this letter, your address is Lebogso Daniel, PO BOX 987, Douala.
2. Describe how your traditional meal is prepared and served.
3. The internet has caused more harm than good to young people in our society. Do you agree?